

NEIVA J. FORTES

570-904-3971 | njfortes@syr.edu | Department of Economics, Syracuse University, Syracuse, NY 13244

EDUCATION

Syracuse University

2022–Present

Ph.D. in Economics, expected May 2027

Dissertation: Essays in the Economics of Education and Health

Dissertation Committee: Monica Deza (Chair), John Cawley, Maria Zhu, and Ying Shi

Hartwick College

2018–2022

B.A. in Mathematics and Economics, summa cum laude

RESEARCH FIELDS

Economics of Education, Health Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Crime

WORKING PAPERS

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying” (*Job Market Paper*)

Recess has long been part of elementary school curricula, yet historically lacked legal protection, allowing schools to restrict access in ways that disproportionately affected minority and low-income students. In 2016, Rhode Island mandated recess statewide. Using nationwide school-level administrative data and synthetic control methods, I estimate the effect of this mandate on discriminatory bullying allegations. By 2018, sex-based bullying allegations increased by an estimated 182 statewide relative to the synthetic control counterfactual, while race- and disability-based allegations were unchanged. The increase is concentrated in high-poverty and high-minority schools, where estimates are roughly five to seven times larger than in their counterparts. The findings are consistent with either increased detection under greater adult supervision or greater exposure to bullying opportunities during unstructured peer interaction.

“The Effect of Height on Adolescents’ Body Image Perceptions and Behaviors”

with Monica Deza and Maria Zhu

NBER Working Paper No. 35293, June 2026. DOI: 10.3386/w35293. [NBER page](#)

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Sibling Spillover Effects of Chronic Illness on Educational and Labor Market Outcomes”

“Height and Bullying: Descriptive Evidence from the YRBSS”

“The Effects of High School Students’ Class Choices on College Outcomes”

“The Effects of Free Jail Call Implementation on Inmates’ Behaviors”

CONFERENCE AND INVITED PRESENTATIONS

** Scheduled*

Southern Economic Association 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX

Nov. 2026*

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying”

APPAM Annual Fall Research Conference

Nov. 2026*

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying” (poster)

FLX Economics of Education Workshop, Syracuse, NY

May 2026

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying”

Center for Policy Research Poster Reception, Syracuse University

2026

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying”

Center for Policy Research Poster Reception, Syracuse University

2025

“The Effects of State-Mandated Recess Laws on Youth Crime”

Invited Seminar, Hartwick College, Oneonta, NY

2025

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying”

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND HONORS

NIA T32 Predoctoral Fellowship in Policy, Place, Population Health, and Aging (P3HA), Syracuse University	2026–2027
Selected Participant, NBER Summer Institute – Economics of Crime, Cambridge, MA	July 2026
Selected Participant, Chicago Price Theory Summer Camp, University of Chicago	June 2026
Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation and Thesis Research	2025–2026
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Syracuse University	2023–2024
McNair Fellowship, Syracuse University	2022–2023
John Christopher Hartwick Scholarship, Hartwick College	2021–2022
Robert E. Newnham '50, H'96 Mathematics Scholarship, Hartwick College	2021–2022
Faculty Scholar, Hartwick College	2021–2022
Andrew B. Saxton Fellowship in Economics and Mathematics, Hartwick College	2020–2022

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Center for Policy Research, Syracuse University	2026–Present
Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Syracuse University	2025–2026
<i>Faculty supervisor: John Cawley</i>	
Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Syracuse University	2024–2025
<i>Faculty supervisors: Monica Deza and Yulya Truskinovsky</i>	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Principles of Microeconomics (ECN 101), Syracuse University	Summers 2024–2026
<i>Enrollment: 12 students (2024), 22 students (2025), and 6 students (2026)</i>	
Teaching Assistant, Intermediate Microeconomics (ECN 301), Syracuse University	2023–2024
<i>Enrollment: Approximately 50-60 students</i>	
Teaching Assistant, Diversity and Democracy, Hartwick College	Jan. 2022
<i>Enrollment: Approximately 15–20 students</i>	

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Director of Admissions, Hartwick College	Jan. 2022
Small Business Coordinator, National Development Council	2021–2022

LANGUAGES

English (fluent) | Cape Verdean Creole (fluent) | Portuguese (fluent) | Spanish (intermediate)

REFERENCES

Monica Deza (Chair), Syracuse University	mdeza@syr.edu
John Cawley, Syracuse University	jhcawley@syr.edu
Maria Zhu, Syracuse University	mzhu33@syr.edu
Ying Shi, Syracuse University	yshi78@syr.edu